

Link Bubble sold to Brave Software; the new browser will enhance the Web experience

Android's browser, Link Bubble, went open source after getting a host of updates, and was sold off by its developer, Chris Lacy, in late 2015.

Brave Software, the company that purchased the browser, is headed by the ex-CEO of Mozilla and the author of JavaScript, Brendan Eich. It has made an announcement that it will be rebranding Link Bubble as just 'Brave'. It has also invited interested parties to test the browser's initial beta release.

One can either sign up for the test of the initial beta release or contribute to the Brave project by viewing the app's code on GitHub.

Eich believes that Brave will ensure enhanced Web browsing. These days, pop-ads litter the Web page and disrupt the reading experience. Tech-savvy people make use of ad-blocker plugins in their browser to solve this issue. Apart from the ads, cookies are also a concern for privacy as they assist in improving the browser experience.

To keep a check on privacy, security, performance, Brave focuses on three main points. It ensures:

- Fast browsing by blocking trackers and intrusive ads
- Secure browsing by blocking harmful advertising and redirecting sites to HTTPS
- Privacy by blocking tracking pixels and tracking cookies

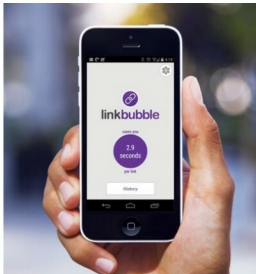
Although these sound like features of a browser plugin, they are not. Brave doesn't really get rid of the ads or cookies. Ads cannot be removed from the website as the publisher of the website relies on the income coming from the ads. Brave merely replaces the Web-ads with its own cleaner ads. In place of cookies, Brave makes use of the local browsing history to offer those cleaner ads. Moreover, Brave obtains a commission from the advertisers for displaying the ads.

All in all, this is just a way of gaining an entry into the Web advertising market without creating an advertising channel like Google AdSense but by creating a Web browser. At present, Brave is in beta and is going to be released for all major OSs.

Microsoft donates its cloud services to NGOs

Microsoft will make a donation of US\$ 1 billion in cloud services to non-profit organisations and universities all over the world in the next three years. This is to promote Azure's public cloud services for the public good. Microsoft will be offering a range of its cloud services, which will include access to Azure cloud computing and Office 365 programs to over 70,000 non-profits and 300 new universities. The announcement was made in an opinion piece in the *Financial Times*.

In the article, Satya Nadella, Microsoft's CEO has pointed out the benefits of



OneOps, an open source platform by Walmart

OneOps by Walmart is a tool for assisting developers in writing, launching and maintaining their apps faster. Walmart had initially planned to open source the service in 2015. According to Walmart CTO, Jeremy King, and WalmartLabs VP of platforms, Tim Kimmet, "It makes sense for Walmart to release OneOps as an open source project, so that the community can improve or build ways for it to adapt to existing technology. We are not strangers to open source. We've been an active contributor, releasing technologies such as Mupd8 and Hapi with the community."

OneOps was acquired by Walmart in 2013, and is being utilised today by more than 3000 engineers within Walmart for building and managing new products. Walmart's e-commerce sites, like walmart.com and Sam's Club, are managed through OneOps. The OneOps platform can work with many public as well as private cloud platforms, which include Microsoft Azure, Rackspace, AWS and CenturyLink Cloud. It can also work with the OpenStack cloud.

The Walmart development team



says it has also worked with the NoSQL database company, Couchbase, to integrate the latter's product into its own stack. OneOps can work with technologies including Node.js, Docker, Elasticsearch, as well as others.

Among its other features are monitoring tools — auto-healing and auto-replace — for when things go wrong, and auto-scaling tools for managing the size of a given cluster. Admins benefit from OneOps by integrating it with enterprise identity services, quota management and configuration management systems.